

Frits Philips

General Info

Birthplace: Zaltbommel

Birthdate: 04-16-1905

Death date: 12-05-2005



Background

Frits Philips was born to Anton Philips and Anna de Jongh in Eindhoven. He was the only son and had two sisters, Annetje and Jetty. Frits attended Reigerlaan elementary school and later pursued mechanical engineering at Delft University of Technology and graduated in 1929. Frits married Sylvia van Lennep in 1929, the same year he graduated, and they had seven children together. Frits was made president of Philips in 1961. **Frits Philips Wikipedia (2025).**

Personality

The biography of Frits Philips presents him as a humble, warm, and genuinely caring person. Frits valued people over profits and treated all employees with respect, showing a combination of authority and approachability. He remained down-to-earth despite his high position, deeply connected to Eindhoven, and concerned about the well-being of those around him.

Even in his personal life, he demonstrated modesty and thoughtfulness, maintaining a relatable, human presence that earned him a lot of admiration. **Omroep Brabant (April 17th 2024)**

History events in lifetime

Nazi Occupation of Eindhoven during World War II (1940–1945)

- **Philips's Resistance Efforts:** During the Nazi occupation, Frits Philips played a pivotal role in protecting Jewish employees at the Philips factories in Eindhoven. He convinced the Nazis that 382 Jewish workers were essential to the company's production, thereby saving their lives. For these actions, he was recognized in 1996 by Yad Vashem as a "Righteous Among the Nations".
- **Personal Detention:** In 1943, Philips was imprisoned in the Vught concentration camp for several months due to a strike at the Philips factory, highlighting his commitment to his workers and the company's operations during the war.

Eindhoven's Post-War Reconstruction (Post-1945)

- **Economic Recovery:** After the war, Eindhoven underwent significant reconstruction. Philips played a crucial role in this process, contributing to the city's economic revival through industrial growth and innovation.
- **Community Engagement:** Philips was deeply involved in the local community, often seen interacting with factory workers and residents, which strengthened his bond with the people of Eindhoven.

Rise of High-Tech Industry in Eindhoven (1950s–1970s)

- **Technological Advancements:** Under Philips's leadership, Eindhoven became a hub for technological innovation. The establishment of the NatLab (Philips Research Laboratories) contributed to advancements in various fields, including electronics and medical technology.
- **Urban Development:** The city's infrastructure expanded to support the growing industrial base, leading to increased employment opportunities and a higher standard of living for its residents.

Influence After Death (2005–Present)

- **Legacy Commemoration:** Following his death in 2005, Eindhoven honored Frits Philips by renaming the city "Frits Philips Stad" for a day and minting a special coin bearing the nickname "Fritske".

- **Cultural Tributes:** The Muziekgebouw Frits Philips concert hall and the restaurant "Meneer Frits" were named in his honor, reflecting his lasting impact on the city's cultural landscape.
- **Memorial Practices:** At PSV Eindhoven, the seat where Philips regularly sat during matches remains empty as a tribute to their devoted supporter

Frits Philips Wikipedia (2025)

Statues

Muziekgebouw

Inside the Muziekgebouw Eindhoven, smaller statues and commemorative representations of Frits Philips are present in the Frits Philips Foyer, highlighting his connection to the cultural and musical life of Eindhoven. **MgE – Een kijkje in onze foyers**

POV:



These statues “face” the foyer spaces and ticket area symbolically overseeing visitors as they enter and enjoy performances, reflecting his enduring presence in the cultural heart of the city.

Eindhoven Markt

The Frits Philips bronze monument at Eindhoven Markt was created by sculptor Kees Verkade and stands on the Markt square. It was unveiled on April 14, 2007, to mark what would have been the 100th birthday of Frits Philips. The initiative came from the Foundation "100 Year Frits Philips" and was financially supported by companies, institutions, and inhabitants of Eindhoven and the surrounding area. **KIJKEN NAAR BEELDEN T.W.M. van Berkel (June 2nd 2019)**

POV:



Frits directly looks at the terrasses, some shops and the Five Guys hamburger restaurant.

Conclusion

A talking statue of Frits Philips would be of real worth as it combines his genial, humble personality with thorough knowledge of the history, culture, and monuments of Eindhoven. The statue could serve as an educational guide, telling visitors about significant sites like the Markt and Muziekgebouw and sharing stories of resilience, innovation, and prudent leadership from Frits's life.

It could also give practical guidance for everyday life: giving directions in the city, suggesting local things to do or cultural events, and explaining historical context for students or tourists. The statue could also serve as a source of inspiration and guidance, to promote such values as fairness, civic responsibility, and people-oriented decision-making, which would reflect how Frits treated residents and employees.

With the combination of historical knowledge, common sense, and spatial awareness, a speaking Frits Philips statue would inform, advise, and motivate citizens and visitors alike, and be both a cultural icon and a useful tool for the citizens and visitors of Eindhoven.

Sources

- Frits Philips Wikipedia (2025) - [Frits Philips - Wikipedia](#)
- Omroep Brabant (April 17th 2024) - <https://www.omroepbrabant.nl/nieuws/4453046/de-mens-achter-meneer-frits-het-verhaal-van-frits-philips-in-nieuw-boek>
- MgE – Een kijkje in onze foyers - [Een kijkje in onze foyers - MgE - Muziekgebouw Eindhoven](#)

- **KIJKEN NAAR BEELDEN T.W.M. van Berkel (June 2nd 2019) -**
<https://vanberkelbeelden.pictures/beeldhouwers/s-z/kees-verkade/frits-philips-eindhoven/>